



Intel Haswell launched

Next generation Core processor from Intel with improved graphics and battery life empowering portable Windows 8 devices. <http://dgit.in/11LTPHV>

Waterproof iCases

Rain is already here. Protect your iPhone 5/4S and 4 from water with these waterproof cases. <http://dgit.in/14aLurv>

Smartphones Test

HOW WE TESTED

Testing a smartphone isn't as simple as it seems. The sheer diversity makes direct comparisons very tough, and hinge on a lot of factors.

First off, we run a series of benchmarks to get a set of numbers allowing us to directly compare the performance of all the devices - processor, graphics, storage and even the web browser. Each platform largely has its own set of benchmarks, with the Browsermark 2.0 and the Octane tests being true cross platform ones. We have given equal weightage to all benchmark scores, so as to not put the other platforms at a disadvantage. Benchmarks for iOS, Android, BlackBerry 10 and Windows Phone devices. These tests give us an idea of how the hardware performs, in isolation as well as comparatively.

Shifting to real-world use, call quality is of paramount importance in a smartphone, and we tested all phones in three different signal zones - full signal, 50% signal and very low signal, usually 1-2 bars. Points are reduced for every call drop, voice echo and audio break situations and also when audio is completely lost. To keep the testing on an even platform, SIM card from the same operator is used on all phones, so that any network variation does not have an impact on the results. Usability is critical, which is why we look at the user interface on the device, the quality of the on-screen keypad, variety of apps preloaded, etc. The build quality, materials used, placement of ports and keys, are other aspects that are tested and rated.

Multimedia, with the current generation of smartphones, gains a lot of importance. We have the tests for display quality, viewing angles, performance of the speaker etc. We also test and rate displays on aspects like usability in sunlight.

The battery life test was done to see how long the phone lasts on a single charge, from full charge to full discharge. The usage included video playback, web browsing and IM chats, a dollop of Angry Birds and some voice calls, all with 3G and Wi-Fi connected throughout.

The hardware and specifications does have considerable amount of weightage to it, and we have allocated points for everything like processor type, display type, etc., to ensure every little nuance is graded accordingly.

the finish, why they did a substantially shoddy job with the Optimus G is mildly shocking.

Nokia Lumia 920:

If you can get beyond the weight issues

The Windows Phone 8 devices carry forward the design elements of the first generation of Lumia smartphones. The Lumia 920 carries forward the work done on the Lumia 900, albeit with slight changes. The unibody carbonate shell now has a slightly shiny finish, as against the complete matte on the Lumia 900. The way it has been put together is absolutely high-end stuff, and we have no complaints there. The way the glass at the front blends into the body of the phone is admirable, and so is the way the power key and volume rockers are placed - with an almost perfect amount of depression to make them usable, yet not protruding out too much. The curved side spines have a positive impact when holding the phone for single hand use. The thickness allows the camera to sit flush with the rest of the back panel, which really

saves the camera from getting scratched. The only real drawback is that the Lumia 920, tipping the scales at 185 grams, is the heaviest phone among all the high-end devices, with the Sony Xperia Z at 146 grams being the second heaviest. But, the multiple colour options make the Lumia 920 a rather interesting device to consider!



LG Nexus 4

Sony Xperia Z: Cannot handle rough use, but can survive a dip

The slab design of the Xperia Z catches the attention almost instantly. Gone are the rounded edges and the slightly curved back cover we had seen on various 2012 Xperia smartphones. This is more like a bar of milk chocolate! For a 5-inch phone, the edges and the straight lines give it an imposing persona - not to mention the chrome-dressed power button. On the front, the 5-inch display sits beneath what Sony calls a shatter-proof and scratch resistant glass (not Gorilla Glass specifically), giving it a very shiny look. The same glass is also on the back, which adds some serious shine to the phone. Equally, we found that the glass on the back caught a lot of scratches very quickly and very easily, something that may not sit well with a lot of users. Coming back to the front, you must have noticed that there are no traditionally seen touch sensitive keys below the display. That is because these keys have been integrated within the on-screen UI. All these connectors and ports are given their own

separate covers, which awards the Xperia Z the IP57 water resistance rating. However, what doesn't really work very well for the Xperia Z is its sheer bulk which just feels too much when compared to the likes of the HTC Butterfly, which also has a 5-inch display.

Samsung Galaxy S4: Plastic is getting on a bit

You were waiting for this, weren't you? Samsung followed the logic of "if it isn't broken, don't fix it" and used the same design philosophy of the SIII. However, plastic doesn't really work anymore, and doesn't hold up against the HTC One and Apple iPhone 5's design. However, this does not take away from Samsung's good work. In the same width as the Galaxy SIII, the Galaxy S4 packs in a bigger display. And while the hardware has been considerably upgraded as well, the Galaxy S4 is slightly thinner than the Galaxy SIII. And, the phone doesn't heat up too much while gaming or running intensive benchmarks. Samsung says that the plastic used on this phone is stronger than the one we saw